

KARUNA KETAN

Game Designer

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PORTFOLIO

karunaket.github.io/karunaketan | [Link](#)

Click to view playable builds, GDDs, and deconstructions.

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Game Designer specializing in **Player Psychology**, **System Design** and **Level Design**, with a focus on crafting strong **gameplay loops** and **immersive player experiences**. Experienced in translating creative pillars into actionable **Game Design Documents (GDDs)** and validating mechanics through **iterative playtesting**. Proven ability to design **spatial layouts** and **progression systems** that drive player engagement.

PROJECTS

Eclipse of Fear (Survival Horror)

Game Designer | [Link](#)

Unreal Engine 5

Jul 2025 – Aug 2025

- Achieved **positive immersion ratings from 15+ playtesters** by designing a diegetic "Lives as Papers" health system that reinforced the horror theme.
- Designed a dynamic pacing curve where tension escalates through enemy waves tied to player progression, ensuring distinct emotional peaks.
- Designed a semi-open campus level using lighting, spatial layout, and inner monologue as invisible tutorials to guide players without UI markers.
- Validated core horror mechanics through a complete playable vertical slice, refining the loop based on feedback regarding start, escalation, and climax.

Shattered Charms: Through The Veil (Action RPG)

System Designer | [Link](#)

Unreal Engine 5

Sep 2025 – Nov 2025

- Designed a Dual-Slot Charm system that replaces skill trees, enabling build experimentation across **10+** modular abilities through discovery rather than XP grinding.
- Balanced a **3-tier progression economy** using Excel to enforce exploration, ensuring players engaged with **100% of core systems** before the final boss.
- Designed a Hub-and-Spoke world structure to control pacing using a **Safety → Tension → Relief** loop.
- Validated progression, economy balance, and combat clarity through repeated playtests and tuning passes.

Project Singularity (Action-Adventure)

Game Designer | [Link](#)

Unreal Engine 5

Nov 2025 – Dec 2025

- Defined spatial metrics and verticality guidelines to support teleportation mechanics, ensuring levels accommodated multiple flanking routes.
- Directed iteration through continuous playtesting with a small team, prioritizing combat feel before content expansion.
- Scoped the project intentionally as a training-focused vertical slice to validate core mechanics before scaling production.

The Last of Us: Part I (Game Deconstruction)

Deconstructor | [Link](#)

Analysis

Sep 2025

- Conducted a breakdown of Naughty Dog's "Scarcity Loops," analyzing how resource limitations (ammo counts, crafting costs) are tuned to subconsciously force defensive playstyles.
- Analyzed the "Pacing Pockets" technique, mapping how environmental storytelling and quiet moments are structured to maximize the impact of combat peaks.
- Deconstructed Naughty Dog's "Invisible Guidance" systems, studying how lighting intensity and geometry (leading lines) direct player navigation without UI.

EDUCATION

B.E. Computer Science and Engineering

KPR Institute of Engineering & Technology 2022 – 2026

Tamil Nadu, India

SKILLS

- System Design & Balancing
- Player Psychology
- Level Design (Blockouts)
- Gameplay Prototyping
- Documentation (GDD, LDD)
- Mechanic Deconstruction
- Flowcharts & Wireframing
- Combat Design & Game Feel

PROTOTYPING & TOOLS

- Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprints)
- Economy Balancing (Excel)
- Unity (Basics)
- Git & Diversion (Version Control)
- Project Management (Trello)
- Miro, Notion, Google Docs

EXPERIENCE

Game Development Club (College)

President

2024 – Present

- Grew community to **200+** active members and shipped 5 student prototypes by mentoring teams in Unreal Engine 5 workflows.
- Directed the club's annual flagship event, managing logistics to facilitate large-scale tournaments and student game showcases.
- Curated and delivered **10+** technical workshops covering **Unreal Engine 5** and **Level Design**, directly mentoring student teams to ship **5** portfolio-ready prototypes.
- Bridged the gap between student developers and industry standards by organizing expert sessions and internal Game Jams.

Akiyam Solutions

Game Design Intern

Jan 2024 – Jul 2024

- Collaborated with the core team to design readable level blockouts, optimizing player navigation and tutorial flow.
- Reduced level iteration loops by **20%** by authoring precise **One-Page Feature Briefs** and **Flowcharts**, preventing design misinterpretations by the art team.